

Uses

Apache attack helicopter

Beryllium alloy window

Fire sprinkler

This seal made of a beryllium-nickel alloy is strong enough to stop high-pressure water supply leaking through.

These beryllium mirror segments will not contract in the cold of space.

James Webb Space Telescope

This airbag is triggered by a sensor that contains beryllium.

Airbag

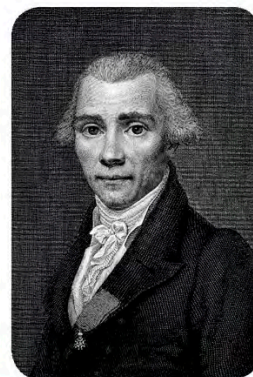
Brake disc

This beryllium disc can withstand higher temperatures than a disc made of aluminium.

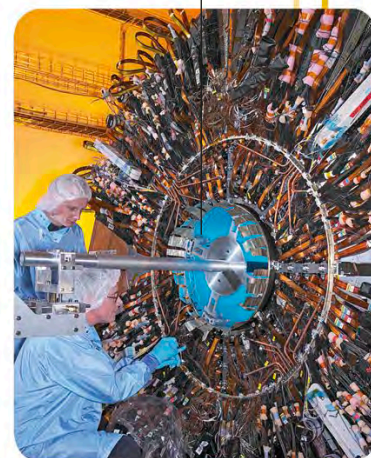


LOUIS NICOLAS VAUQUELIN

Beryllium was discovered in 1798 by the French chemist Louis Nicolas Vauquelin. He extracted the pure metal from emerald, which is a valuable green form of the mineral beryl. He had already discovered the element chromium, which is also found in emerald and gives it its green colour.



This beryllium pipe delivers beams of protons into this device.



ATLAS, a device at the Large Hadron Collider, CERN, Switzerland

of beryllium-rich glass to shield optical sensors to aid pilots flying at night or through fog. Objects made of this metal keep their shape well and hardly expand or contract if the temperature changes. This makes beryllium useful in valves for **fire sprinklers** and car

sensors that trigger **airbags**. NASA's **James Webb Space Telescope** will use a large beryllium mirror that is light and strong. Beryllium is also used to make **brake discs** for racing cars. Alloys of beryllium and copper are used in springs as well.